

Community Forum - Working Prototype

A fully functional community forum prototype built with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, following the exact styling and functionality of the Odoo forum platform.

Features

Core Functionality

- **Question & Answer System:** Browse, ask, and answer questions
- **User Management:** User profiles with reputation, badges, and statistics
- **Tag System:** Organize questions by tags with filtering capabilities
- **Search & Filter:** Real-time search and advanced filtering options
- **Voting System:** Upvote/downvote questions and answers
- **Responsive Design:** Mobile-first responsive layout

Pages Included

- **Homepage (index.html):** Main forum listing with questions
- **Question Detail (question-detail.html):** Individual question view with answers
- **Ask Question (ask-question.html):** Form to submit new questions
- **Users (users.html):** Community user directory
- **Tags (tags.html):** Browse all available tags

Advanced Features

- **Auto-save Draft:** Automatic saving of question drafts
- **Tag Suggestions:** Intelligent tag suggestions while typing
- **Form Validation:** Client-side validation with error handling
- **Loading States:** Visual feedback during operations
- **Keyboard Shortcuts:** Ctrl/Cmd+K for search focus
- **Analytics Tracking:** Event tracking framework (placeholder)

Project Structure

```
forum-project/  
├── index.html          # Main forum homepage  
├── question-detail.html # Individual question view
```

```
├── ask-question.html      # Ask new question form
├── users.html             # User directory
├── tags.html              # Tag browser
├── README.md              # This file
├── css/
│   └── styles.css         # All styling (responsive)
├── js/
│   └── main.js            # All JavaScript functionality
├── assets/
│   ├── logo.svg           # Main logo (dark)
│   └── logo-white.svg     # Footer logo (white)
```

Design System

Color Palette

- **Primary:**  #ff7a00 (Orange)
- **Secondary:**  #99ad8a (Green)
- **Text:**  #777 (Gray)
- **Background:**  #fafafa (Light Gray)
- **Border:**  #ddd (Light Border)

Typography

- **Font Family:** System fonts (system-ui, -apple-system, Segoe UI, Roboto, Helvetica, Arial)
- **Accent Font:** 'Sansation' (Google Fonts) for headings
- **Font Sizes:** Responsive scaling from 0.8rem to 3rem

Layout

- **Max Width:** 1200px centered layout
- **Responsive:** Mobile-first approach
- **Grid System:** CSS Grid and Flexbox
- **Border Radius:** 10px for cards, 6px for forms

Setup Instructions

1. Download Files

Download all files maintaining the exact folder structure shown above.

2. Local Development

```
bash

# Option 1: Simple HTTP Server (Python)
python -m http.server 8000

# Option 2: Node.js HTTP Server
npx http-server

# Option 3: PHP Development Server
php -S localhost:8000
```

3. Open in Browser

Navigate to `http://localhost:8000` to view the forum.

4. Customization

1. **Logo:** Replace `assets/logo.svg` and `assets/logo-white.svg` with your logos
2. **Colors:** Update CSS variables in `:root` section of `styles.css`
3. **Content:** Modify the placeholder content in HTML files
4. **Functionality:** Extend JavaScript in `main.js` for additional features

Technical Details

CSS Architecture

- **CSS Custom Properties:** Consistent theming with CSS variables
- **Mobile-First:** All styles written mobile-first with progressive enhancement
- **Component-Based:** Modular CSS classes for reusability
- **Animation:** Subtle hover effects and transitions

JavaScript Features

- **ES6+:** Modern JavaScript with arrow functions, const/let, template literals
- **Event Delegation:** Efficient event handling
- **Local Storage:** Draft auto-save functionality
- **Form Validation:** Real-time validation with user feedback
- **Search:** Client-side filtering and search

Browser Support

- **Modern Browsers:** Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge (latest 2 versions)
- **Mobile:** iOS Safari, Chrome Mobile
- **Fallbacks:** Graceful degradation for older browsers

Responsive Breakpoints

- **Mobile:** < 480px
- **Tablet:** 481px - 768px
- **Desktop:** 769px - 1200px
- **Large Desktop:** > 1200px

Production Deployment

Static Hosting

This forum can be deployed to any static hosting service:

- **Netlify:** Drag & drop deployment
- **Vercel:** Git-based deployment
- **GitHub Pages:** Repository-based hosting
- **AWS S3:** Static website hosting

CDN Integration

For production, consider:

- Image optimization
- CSS/JS minification
- CDN for static assets
- Performance monitoring

Integration Options

Backend Integration

To make this a fully functional forum:

1. **API Integration:** Replace mock data with real API calls
2. **User Authentication:** Integrate with OAuth providers or custom auth

3. **Database:** Connect to database for persistent storage
4. **Real-time Updates:** Add WebSocket for live updates
5. **File Uploads:** Add support for image/file attachments

Recommended Stack

- **Backend:** Node.js/Express, Python/Django, or PHP/Laravel
- **Database:** PostgreSQL, MongoDB, or MySQL
- **Authentication:** Firebase Auth, Auth0, or custom JWT
- **Real-time:** Socket.io or Server-Sent Events



Analytics & Monitoring

The prototype includes placeholder analytics tracking:

- Page views
- User interactions
- Performance metrics
- Error tracking

Integrate with services like:

- Google Analytics
- Mixpanel
- Sentry (error tracking)
- Core Web Vitals monitoring



Security Considerations

For production deployment:

- Implement Content Security Policy (CSP)
- Add input sanitization
- Use HTTPS everywhere
- Implement rate limiting
- Add CSRF protection
- Regular security audits



Contributing

This is a prototype/template. To extend:

1. Follow the existing code style
2. Test all responsive breakpoints
3. Ensure accessibility compliance
4. Update documentation

License

This prototype is provided as-is for educational and development purposes. Customize freely for your projects.

Support

For questions about implementation or customization:

1. Review the code comments
2. Check browser developer tools for errors
3. Verify file paths and structure
4. Test in different browsers

Built with  following Odoo forum design patterns